Association des piétons et cyclistes de NDG (APC-NDG)

Montréal, November 2, 2026

To the secrétaire d'arrondissement
Division du greffe
Borough of Côte-des-Neiges–Notre-Dame-de-Grâce
5160 boulevard Décarie
suite 600
Montréal

Subject: First results of the survey « Terrebonne en hiver » (Terrebonne in winter), handed over at the borough council sitting of Monday, November 2, 2026

Madam,

Purpose and method. On behalf of the Association des piétons et cyclistes de NDG, we hand over, for the attention of the borough council, the first results of the online survey « Terrebonne en hiver », open since October 15, 2026, on parking and winter cycling on rue de Terrebonne and the streets around it. The survey exists because the borough's file on the proposed winter conversion, released under access request 2026-581, contains no inventory of on-street parking, no occupancy count, and no survey on the impact of the proposed changes on households that use the Terrebonne bike path in winter. The survey is voluntary; it counts the people who answered and does not claim to measure a share of residents. Its method is described in the attached note.

Who answered. Between October 15 and November 2, 2026, **205** people answered. The counts below are limited to the **161** respondents with a stake in the street: those who live on Terrebonne or within one block, or who cycled on Terrebonne last winter. The **44** excluded live elsewhere in the borough or outside it and did not cycle on rue de Terrebonne last winter. The survey links carried referral codes: of the **161**, **37** came through channels aligned with cycling interests, **5** through channels aligned with driving interests, **20** through groups opposed to the bike path, and **99** through neutral local channels, unknown sources, or a public Facebook forum on the Terrebonne lane where both sides post. The sample is not strictly representative of the borough's residents or of the lane's users, but it was not drawn predominantly from one camp or the other. The figures are counts of respondents, not estimates of prevalence: each says that at least this many of the people reached by the survey answered this way, and nothing about those who did not see or answer it.

Winter cyclists. **87** respondents cycled on Terrebonne last winter, **36** of them at least weekly; **27** said a child rides on Terrebonne in winter. Asked how safe they would feel cycling in the traffic lane beside parked cars, **80** of the **87** said less than safe: **40** too unsafe for themselves or their children and **40** uncomfortable but willing; **7** said safe enough. Asked what they would do if one direction became parking, **46** said they would keep cycling in the shared traffic lane, **43** of them despite feeling the arrangement would be less than safe; **20** said they would drive, take transit or walk, or give up trips altogether; **12** gave another answer, mostly a detour by another street; and **9** did not know.

Parking near Terrebonne. **108** respondents live on Terrebonne or within a block; **59** of them had parked on the street the night before, and **34** of those reported winter parking hardship under a strict criterion (on a typical evening, ten minutes or more to find a space, or a space two blocks or more away; or, after a storm or during snow loading, a car parked two blocks or more away, ticketed, towed or moved out of the neighbourhood), **46** under a looser hardship criterion that adds « took much longer to find a space » after a storm. **37** respondents have someone in the household with a lot of difficulty walking, and **18** of them are street parkers with hardship. The survey asked no question about age. The two situations overlap: **16** of the **59** street parkers are themselves winter cyclists and **11** have a child who rides in winter.

Preference among the three options. On the preference question, which offered the borough's three options, **91** of the **161** chose to keep the protected lane in both directions, **57** to convert one direction to parking for the winter and **12** to allow parking only during snow-loading operations; the **44** excluded split **17**, **19** and **7**. **Four** comments, **three** of them among the **161**, asked for no bike path at all, an option the question did not offer. The preference figures describe who answered, not the neighbourhood.

Off-street parking on Terrebonne. For context, outside the survey's scope: a reading of the 1954–55 Underwriters' insurance plans (BAnQ) and of high-resolution optical and LiDAR imagery from provincial and municipal open sources (public work, Terrebonne-open-sources) finds a garage or driveway at about 72 % of the buildings with a Terrebonne address today, 70 % of dwellings; among the survey's respondents living on Terrebonne who keep a vehicle, **18** of **34** report at least one off-street place of their own, a lower share but within what a sample of that size can show.

Winter days with a snow constraint. For context, outside the survey's scope: records from Environment Canada and the City's open data on snow-loading operations indicate that, of the 121 winter days from December 1, 2025 to March 31, 2026, snow-loading operations took place in the sector that includes Terrebonne on 30 days, and 44 days fall within an episode running from the triggering snowfall to the end of loading; the other 77 days presented no snow-related constraint on parking. Over the five winters from 2021–22 to 2025–26, the averages for the same sector are 23 loading days and 32 days within such episodes, out of 121.

Attachment and next steps. Attachments: the survey's methods note, French and English, and, as an annex to this letter, the reach of the links by channel. The survey will remain open until shortly before the council sitting of December 7, 2026; a full report, with the anonymized response file, will be released at that time, published on the Association's website and transmitted to council. Further detail, the tables by district and referral channel, and the anonymized response file (free-text comments reproduced as written) are available to the borough on request.

Two figures for council. Two figures from this filing bear directly on the decision before council: at least **87** respondents cycled on Terrebonne last winter, and **27** said a child rides on Terrebonne in winter; and, by the City's own snow records, about two-thirds of last winter's days, and about three-quarters on the five-winter average, presented no snow-related constraint on parking.

Requests. We ask that this document be recorded under Correspondance in the minutes of the sitting of November 2, 2026, that it be transmitted to the members of council, and that you acknowledge its receipt in writing.

Yours sincerely,

Jason Savard, for the Association des piétons et cyclistes de NDG
ndgcycle@gmail.com

Annex: reach of the links. The survey links were posted through channels of four kinds, the classes used above for the respondents' origin. The table gives, for each class, the channels, their membership as displayed on November 2, 2026 (memberships overlap, and a post reaches only part of a group's members), and the responses, for all **205** respondents and for the **161** with a stake in the street. Membership is the figure the platform displays, rounded as shown; the fourth class's total is almost entirely r/Montreal's 326,000, the four NDG neighbourhood groups together having 41,655 members. The counts say where the links were posted and how many answered, not how many saw them. The survey was online and reached people mainly through social media; residents less present there, older residents among them, are likely under-represented. Paper notices in apartment buildings and a seniors' residence brought one response.

Channels	Members	Responses	Of the 161
Aligned with cycling interests	**27,627**	**43**	**37**
Vélo d'hiver – Montréal (Facebook, public)	26,000	27	
APC-NDG Facebook page (followers)	1,400	1	
Terrebonne Bike Path, the APC-NDG members' group (Facebook)	224	10	
APC-NDG e-mail list (count requested)	–	3	
APC-NDG Slack	3	2	
Opposed to the bike path	**602**	**23**	**20**
Association de voisinage de la rue de Terrebonne (Facebook)	602	23	
Aligned with driving interests	**5,100**	**6**	**5**
Les automobilistes de Montréal et du Québec (Facebook, public)	5,100	6	
Neutral local channels, the open forum, and unknown	**367,857**	**133**	**99**
Thrive NDG (Facebook)	23,900	9	
Parents NDG (Facebook)	11,000	3	
NDG Living (Facebook)	5,900	11	
NDG Winning (Facebook)	855	23	
Terrebonne Bike Path Open Discussion Forum (Facebook, public)	202	13	
Reddit: r/Montreal (members); r/MontrealCycling, 11,000 weekly visitors	326,000	1	
Instagram (followers not tracked)	–	5	
Flyers, QR cards, signs on Terrebonne, notices in buildings	–	11	
Language switch inside the form (origin not recorded)	–	28	
Code blank, edited by the respondent, or « other »	–	29	
All channels		**205**	**161**

Terrebonne in winter: how the survey works

Methods note published by the Association des piétons et cyclistes de NDG (APC-NDG) with the survey. Version of October 28, 2026 (October 16 text; section 2 aligned with the cover letter of October 29). The survey opened on the evening of October 15, 2026; all times are Montréal time.

1. What this note is for

The survey asks residents of the borough of Côte-des-Neiges–Notre-Dame-de-Grâce and the surrounding area, and anyone who uses rue de Terrebonne wherever they live, about parking and winter cycling on and around the street, before the council of the borough of Côte-des-Neiges–Notre-Dame-de-Grâce votes on a winter configuration of the protected bike lane. This note says who runs the survey, what it asks, what it does not collect, how the answers will be counted and published, and what its limits are. The questions and their wording were settled before the first response was received; every change made to the forms, with its time, is listed in section 8.

2. Who does what

- The survey is run by the APC-NDG, a volunteer association. The Association owns the data and will publish the results and the anonymized file on its website and Facebook page.
- A member of the Association administers the two Google Forms (English and French) and produces the tables, as a volunteer. That person does not promote the survey; the links are for the Association's website and newsletter and for anyone to share.
- The survey is not run by, or for, the borough. It exists because the borough's file on the proposed winter change, released under access request 2026-581 (508 pages, October 9, 2026), contains no inventory of on-street parking, no occupancy count, no estimate of the spaces the change would create, and no survey on the impact of the proposed changes on households that use the Terrebonne bike path in winter. The survey is an attempt to put some counts on the record; it is not a scientific sample and is not presented as one.
- The survey is distinct from the petition being circulated door to door. Nobody is asked survey questions on their doorstep.

3. Questions raised about the survey

Since launch, the following objections have been made publicly, mostly in neighbourhood discussion groups. They are listed here, without attribution, because a methods note should answer them where everyone can see.

1. **"It indirectly collects a lot of personal information."** Section 5 lists every field, marks the optional ones, and gives the rule that prevents any published table from describing fewer than five respondents.
2. **"It is not led by the borough, so it has little value."** Section 2 says why a resident survey exists. Its value is counts that would otherwise not exist, published with their limitations.
3. **"It will have a low response rate from borough residents."** Probably true, and said in the introduction: the survey is voluntary. The published counts by district and by referral channel (section 6) will show how many corridor residents answered, so the point can be checked rather than argued.
4. **"It cannot be neutral, because a cycling association runs it."** The questions are public, the anonymized answers will be public, every result is published whether favourable or not, and the parking questions are asked of drivers in the same detail as the cycling questions are asked of cyclists. A driver who does not answer leaves no record of their parking problem.

5. **"It does not offer the option of removing the whole path in winter."** The preference question is a forced choice among the options described for this winter (section 4): the current layout; converting one direction to parking for the whole winter, which the councillor said on October 6 the borough would propose; and parking in the lane only during snow-loading operations, one of the scenarios in the mandate the borough gave its engineering firm. The same mandate also listed closing the lane completely in winter among the scenarios to compare; it is not what the borough has said it will propose, and it is not offered. A respondent who wants the lane removed altogether can choose the closest option, converting one direction for the whole winter, and say so in the open field at the end. The count for that option therefore includes people who would go further, and mentions of complete removal and of other options in the open field are counted and reported.
6. **"Allowing parking in the lane during snow clearing is moot if the street has to be cleared."** This concerns one of the options in the question, not the survey. The option means opening the lane to parked cars only during a declared snow-loading operation, when parking on the roadway side being cleared is banned for a day or two. The survey asks about it; it does not advocate it.
7. **"The Association's members will flood the survey."** Every response carries the referral code of the channel it came through (section 6), and the counts by referral channel are published, so answers that arrive through the Association's own channels are visible as such and can be set aside by any reader. The survey counts the people who answered; it does not claim a share of residents (section 9).

4. What is asked

The form is bilingual and takes two to three minutes. Branching means that a respondent who neither drives nor cycles sees about seven questions, and only someone who both drives and cycles on Terrebonne in winter sees all fifteen.

Everyone

- Reference code (filled in automatically from the link used; see section 6).
- How you got the survey.
- Where you live: on rue de Terrebonne; within one block of it between Somerled and Monkland; elsewhere in Loyola district; elsewhere in Notre-Dame-de-Grâce district; Snowdon district; elsewhere in NDG, not sure which district; elsewhere in the borough; outside the borough.
- Nearest cross street to your home (**optional**).
- First three characters of your postal code, for example H4B (**optional**; the form accepts three characters only).
- Whether anyone in your household, including you, has a lot of difficulty walking or climbing steps.
- How many cars, vans or light trucks your household keeps at home.

If the household keeps a vehicle (page "Parking in winter")

- How many parking places your home has that are not on the street, and how many are used for a vehicle now.
- Where the vehicle(s) you drive parked last night.
- Last winter, on a typical evening, how long it took to find an on-street space, and how far from your door the space was.
- What happened after a major snowfall or during a snow-loading operation last winter.

Everyone: whether you cycled on rue de Terrebonne last winter.

If you cycle on Terrebonne (page "Your winter bike trips on Terrebonne")

- If one direction of the protected lane became parking from December to March, what you would most likely do for most of your winter bike trips in that direction (one answer).
- How safe you would feel cycling in the traffic lane with parked cars on your right.
- Whether children ride on Terrebonne with you or on their own.

Everyone (last page)

- Which option for December to March you would prefer. The form reads "The borough is considering three options for December to March. Which would you prefer?", with the choices: keep the protected lane in both directions all winter (as now); convert one direction to parking for the whole winter; keep the lane, but allow parking in it only during declared snow-loading operations; no preference. One answer (forced choice; see section 3, point 5).
- Anything else, in your own words (**optional**).

A separate, optional contact form, reached from the thank-you page, lets a respondent leave an e-mail address to be told when results are published, to receive the newsletter, or to volunteer. That form is a different file: nothing links an address given there to a survey response.

5. What is never collected, and the privacy rules

- No name, no e-mail address, no street address, no telephone number. No sign-in is required and Google Forms does not record the respondent's IP address for this survey.
- The two location details beyond the district, the nearest cross street and the three-character postal-code prefix, are optional. They exist to let the Association check that responses are consistent (a resident of Terrebonne with a postal code from another part of the city is a flag) and to describe how far the survey reached. A three-character prefix covers thousands of addresses; it cannot identify a building.
- **Publication rule.** No published table will describe fewer than five respondents. Cells below that size are merged with their neighbours. No table is published at the level of a block or a cross street. In the published file, the cross street and the postal prefix are removed or coarsened so that no combination of answers points to a household.
- **The raw file.** The complete response file, with the optional location details, is held for the Association by the member who administers the forms, in a Google account to which only that person has access. It is used only to produce the tables and run the checks in section 6, and is deleted when that work ends, by March 31, 2027 at the latest. The anonymized file (the published one) is offered to the borough.
- **The contact form.** E-mail addresses left on the separate contact form are kept apart from the survey, used only for the purposes ticked, and deleted on March 31, 2027 unless the person asked for the newsletter.
- **Short links.** The short links (tinyurl.com/…) pass through TinyURL on the way to the form; TinyURL handles each click under its own privacy policy, and the Association sees only aggregate click counts for each link, never who clicked. The full links go straight to Google Forms and do not pass through TinyURL.

6. How the answers are counted

- **The person is the unit.** Everyone answers for themselves, in both the parking and the cycling blocks. A household with two drivers has two parking experiences. Two questions describe the household as a whole (vehicles kept at home, off-street places) and are reported as "respondents whose household has…", never summed into a count of cars or households.
- **Counts, not percentages.** Results are reported as counts: "at least N respondents who ride Terrebonne in winter carry children on it"; "at least N residents spent more than ten minutes

looking for a space on a typical winter evening". Percentages of a voluntary sample mean little and are not the point.

- **By district and by referral channel.** Every table is given for the corridor (on Terrebonne or within one block) and for each other district separately, and the number of responses by link code is published, so that readers can see where the answers came from. A burst of responses from one link is visible.
- **Link codes.** Each link posted carries a short referral code identifying the channel it was posted through (website, newsletter, a Facebook group, a school notice, a member's share). The code itself carries no meaning; the Association keeps the table that matches each code to its channel, and the published tables name the channel. Respondents can edit or delete the code. A blank code is reported as "channel unknown"; it is never guessed. Since 22:03 on October 15, switching language inside the form is recorded as its own code (section 8).
- **Consistency checks**, fixed in advance and applied when the tables are produced, with the results published: the postal prefix against the stated district; near-duplicate responses (same block and side, same household composition, same off-street answers) flagged and reported, not deleted. Nothing short of verified identity can prevent a person from answering twice; the published rules and the published file are the defence.
- **Open comments** are reported verbatim, unattributed, with the referral code; they are published as written, without editing. The words are the respondents' own: editing them would mean choosing among them, so none is shortened, softened or left out, including those critical of the survey or of the Association.

7. Dates and publication

- First cut: end of day October 28, 2026 (moved from October 29 on October 28, when the borough set Thursday, October 29 at noon as the deadline for correspondence to the sitting of Monday, November 2, the sitting having been moved from its usual Tuesday). Results "as of October 28, N responses" are produced for that sitting.
- Close: end of day November 25, 2026. Final tables are produced for the council meeting of December 7.
- No results are released before a cut-off. Every result is published, favourable or not, with the anonymized file, on the Association's website and Facebook page.

8. Changes made to the forms

The questions, the answer choices and the routing are the same for every respondent. The changes below are all the changes made to the forms since the evening of October 15, with the time each was applied.

- **October 15, 19:08 and 19:46, before the first response.** After review comments from members, the wording of five titles was clarified: the vehicles question ("does your household keep at home"), the off-street places question ("count the places, not the cars"), the title of the cycling page ("bike trips"), the children question (rewritten as a question), and the cycling scenario question ("pick the one that best describes… most of your winter bike trips"). The meaning of each was the same before and after. The first response was recorded at 20:23, so every response was given to the final wording.
- **October 15, 22:03.** The link to the other language in each form's description was given its own code. Before then, a respondent who switched language inside the form arrived with a blank code; those responses are reported as "channel unknown".
- **October 16, 09:11.** The code field was renamed from "Link code" to "Reference (filled in automatically; leave as is)". Its position and behaviour did not change.

- **October 16.** Every channel was given a six-character referral code that carries no meaning, and the short links were re-issued. One code posted on October 15 had described its channel in words; it was replaced. Codes issued before October 16 remain valid and are counted with the channel they were issued for.

9. Known limitations

- The survey is voluntary and self-selected. It cannot say what share of residents hold a view or face a problem. It can say that at least N people do.
- The mobility question allows one answer, so a respondent who has a limitation and lives with someone who does cannot say both; the two "yes" answers are pooled.
- "Same block" is not a fixed distance; on a long block it can mean several addresses.
- The preference question is a forced choice; complete removal of the lane in winter is not offered. Respondents who want it are expected to choose the closest option (converting one direction for the whole winter), so that option's count includes them. Mentions in the open comments are counted and reported separately and are not used to re-assign answers.
- The link code can be edited by the respondent. Referral channels are therefore indicative.
- Responses from outside NDG are welcome (the cycling questions apply to anyone who rides Terrebonne) and are always reported separately from residents'.

10. Where to find things

The full questionnaire in both languages, this note, the published tables and the anonymized file will be on the Association's website. The borough's file on the proposed change (access request 2026-581) and the summaries of it are public at openmobilitydata.github.io/Terrebonne-access-requests.